

All about me

- **BORN:** 1398
- **DIED:** 1468
- **NATIONALITY:** German
- **FACTOID:** I was a printer and publisher.
- **IN A NUTSHELL:** Born in Mainz, Germany, I invented the printing press—one of the most important inventions of the modern era.

Johann Gutenberg

The man who helped put a **BOOK** in everyone's hands, and opened up reading to the masses

Secret experiments

Gutenberg *enjoyed reading* and thought it was a pity that only rich people could afford to buy books. In a **secret workshop** he experimented with individual, movable letters, and new oil-based inks. For his printing press, he adapted the presses that were for winemaking at the time. In 1454, he was successful, and he printed his landmark book, the **GUTENBERG BIBLE**.

Gutenberg's first Bible cost about three years' wages at the time... they got cheaper.

Reading revolution

News of Gutenberg's innovation **soon spread around Europe** and, before he died, presses like his were at work in all Europe's great cities. The printing press allowed ideas and information to spread like never before, so that everyone, rich or poor, could **ENJOY READING**.



Gutenberg experimented with wooden type, but ended up using metal letters because they didn't smudge.

By the way... my secretive work left some of my neighbors believing I was a wizard who had secret meetings with the devil!